BRD Reconstruction

An AI agent, run inside VS Code with GitHub Copilot, that rebuilds business requirement documents for systems that already exist but were never properly documented. It reads everything the team has, works out what the system does and why, and writes the BRD section by section. A person reviews every step before it moves on.

The problem
Pipelines, stored procedures and tables exist, but the business reasons behind them are scattered or lost. Developers reverse-engineer by hand.

What the agent does
Builds a shared memory from all available evidence, then drafts each BRD phase and asks questions where the evidence runs out.

What people do
Review each phase in a browser page, answer questions, correct the agent, and approve before the next phase starts.

What comes out
A BRD in the client's template, where every statement shows where it came from and whether a person confirmed it.

How it works, end to end

The work happens in two stages. First the agent builds a **memory** of the system from every source available. Then, using that memory, it builds **one BRD** phase by phase. Each phase ends with a review page and a person's decision.

Agent does the work · Person approves before moving on · Person reviews; approval not required

START

Setup
Project name. Check the sources folder for the BRD template, Databricks details and Genie access. Ask for anything missing.

Confirmed by you

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Stage 1 · Build the memory

done once, then updated whenever new evidence arrives

M1
Collect the evidence
Register every file: docs, slides, spreadsheets, images, pipeline JSON, team BRDs, other agents' notes.

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M2
Map the technology
Every table, view, stored procedure and pipeline: what it reads, writes and does. Data lineage end to end.

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M3
Understand the business
Why each flow likely exists, business terms linked to technical objects, how areas relate. Asks for supporting documents where evidence is thin.

→

M4
Memory review
You read the agent's picture of the system and correct it.

Feedback, then proceed

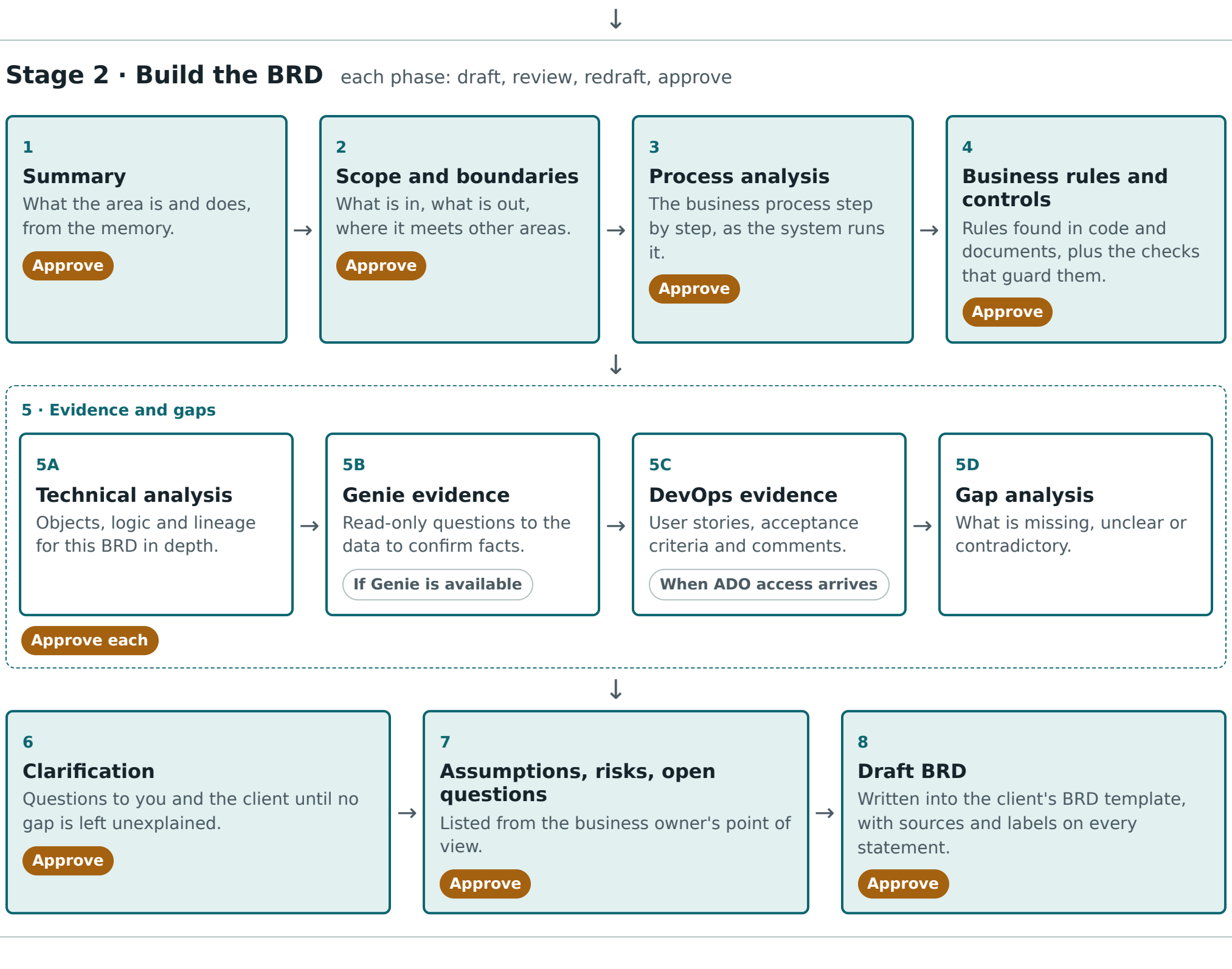
↻ **Update memory any time.** A new document arrives: the agent adds it, shows what changed, and saves the next memory version.

↓

BRD

Choose the BRD
The agent proposes candidate BRDs from the memory, or you give a short summary of the one you want. One BRD per workspace.

Approved by you



The review loop at every step

The agent never moves on by itself. Every phase follows the same four steps, and the person decides when it is finished.

1 · Agent drafts
Works from the memory and evidence, and writes the phase.

2 · Agent publishes a review page
A readable HTML page in the browser, with answer boxes for every question.

3 · You review
Mark sections, answer questions, add comments, in the page or in chat.

4 · Agent redrafts
Applies the feedback and publishes the next round. Earlier rounds are kept.

The loop repeats until the agent states it has no further questions for this phase and you are satisfied. You then reply with one word:

FEEDBACK	Change something. The agent redrafts this phase.
APPROVED	The phase is done. The agent records it and waits.
PROCEED	Memory review only: move on without formal approval.
HALT	Stop now. Pick up later from the same point.

Only a person can approve. The agent then waits for you to start the next phase; it does not start it on its own.

Stage 1 in detail: building the memory

The memory is the agent's organised understanding of the whole system. It is stored as files in the workspace, not in the chat, so work can resume in a new session and anyone can inspect it.

Step	What the agent does	What you do	Result
Setup	Asks for the project name; checks the sources folder for the BRD template, Databricks details and Genie access details; asks for whatever is missing.	Put files in the sources folder (all as Markdown). Say whether Genie is available.	Project set up; Genie marked as in use or not in use
M1 Collect	Registers every source file with what it is and its date. Reads team-prepared BRDs and other agents' notes as unconfirmed input.	Add anything the agent asks for.	Evidence register
M2 Map	Reads stored procedures, tables, views and pipeline definitions in batches. Records what each reads, writes and does, and traces data from source to consumer. Uses Genie (read-only) if available.	Nothing, unless asked.	Technical catalog and lineage
M3 Understand	Works out the likely purpose of each flow, links business terms to technical objects, and finds how areas relate. Asks for supporting documents where evidence is thin.	Provide supporting documents when asked.	Business picture, purpose of each flow, relationships
M4 Review	Publishes the memory as a review page, highlighting what it is least sure about.	Read it, correct it, then reply FEEDBACK or PROCEED.	Memory v1 **Advisory**

What the memory holds

- A register of every source
- A card for every table, view, procedure and pipeline
- Data lineage from source to consumer
- Business terms and the objects that implement them
- The likely purpose of each flow, with its evidence
- Relationships to other areas and other BRDs
- Summaries at three levels: object, area, whole system

Updating the memory

- New documents can arrive at any time.
- The agent adds them and shows what is new, what changed, what is contradicted and what is confirmed.
- Each update creates the next memory version, with a change log.
- Earlier versions are kept, so it is always clear what a BRD was built on.

Stage 2 in detail: building the BRD

One BRD per workspace. The agent proposes candidate BRDs from the memory, or the user describes the one they need in a short summary. Each phase then runs the review loop and needs approval.

Phase	What the agent produces	What you do	Gate
1 Summary	A plain description of the area: what it does, who uses it, main data and flows.	Check it describes the right thing.	**Approve**
2 Scope and boundaries	What is in and out, the inputs and outputs, where it meets other areas.	Confirm the boundaries.	**Approve**
3 Process analysis	The business process step by step, mapped to the pipelines and procedures that run it.	Correct steps that are wrong or missing.	**Approve**
4 Rules and controls	Business rules found in code and documents, and the checks that protect them.	Confirm which rules are intended.	**Approve**
5A Technical analysis	The objects, logic and lineage behind this BRD in depth.	Review.	**Approve**
5B Genie evidence	Read-only questions to the data, each with the query used, to confirm facts. Skipped and stated if Genie is not available.	Confirm or correct each finding.	**Approve**
5C DevOps evidence	User stories, acceptance criteria and comments from Azure DevOps. Marked "not available yet" until access is granted.	Confirm what applies.	**Approve**
5D Gap analysis	Everything missing, unclear or contradictory across all evidence.	Check nothing important is missed.	**Approve**

Phase	What the agent produces	What you do	Gate
6 Clarification	Questions in rounds, each with options and a suggested answer.	Answer, or get answers from the client.	Approve
7 Assumptions, risks, open questions	Everything still uncertain, from the business owner's point of view, with owners.	Agree the list.	Approve
8 Draft BRD	The complete BRD in the client's template, as a document and a readable web page.	Final review.	Approve

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How the BRD stays trustworthy

Because the requirements are rebuilt from evidence rather than written by the business, readers need to see what has been confirmed and what has not. Every statement in the memory and in the BRD carries one of four labels, plus where it came from.

Confirmed
A person confirmed it, with their name and date.

From evidence
Seen directly in a document, the code, a pipeline or the data.

Inferred
The agent's reading, such as the likely purpose of a procedure. Needs confirmation.

Conflicting
Two sources disagree. Raised as a question, never settled silently.

Team-prepared BRDs and other agents' notes enter as **Inferred**. They are useful starting points, but nothing from them counts as confirmed until a person says so.

Versions on every document

Each BRD shows the memory version it was built on, on its cover and in its change log:

BRD v3	Built on Memory v2

When the memory is updated later, the BRD shows a notice such as

Built on Memory v2 · current memory is v4

The agent does not change the BRD on its own. The user decides whether to revisit it with the newer memory. Nothing is ever overwritten: every review round, feedback file, memory version and BRD version is kept.

Safeguards

People stay in control

- Only a person can approve a phase.
- The agent asks when unsure; it does not guess.
- Conflicts between sources are raised, never resolved silently.

Read-only access to data

- Genie is used only to read, through a read-only account.
- Every query the agent relies on is checked and shown.
- Nothing in Databricks or Azure DevOps is ever changed.

No secrets exposed

- Access tokens are never typed into the chat or saved in files.
- VS Code asks for them in its own secure prompt.
- Sensitive data is summarised or masked, not copied.

How teams use it

The playbook is shared with the team. Each user takes a copy into their own workspace and works on one BRD there. For example, one analyst works on BRD 1 and a colleague on BRD 2, each with their own memory and review pages.

- One BRD at a time in a workspace. A new BRD means a new workspace.
- A colleague's memory or BRD can be added as input. It comes in as Inferred until confirmed.

- The memory records where each BRD connects to other areas, so related BRDs can be joined up later.

What is needed to start

Tools

- VS Code with GitHub Copilot (agent mode)
- MCP servers allowed in the organisation's Copilot settings
- The playbook files copied into the workspace

Inputs

- All available documents, converted to Markdown
- The client's BRD template
- Databricks details; Genie access details if available
- Pipeline definitions (JSON) where available

People and approvals

- An analyst per BRD to run the playbook and review
- Access to subject experts or the client for clarifications
- Policy approval to process client material with Copilot
- Later: read-only Azure DevOps access

Limits to be aware of

- **Evidence sets the ceiling.** The agent can only rebuild what the evidence shows. Where intent was never written down, the BRD will mark it Inferred until someone confirms it.
- **The memory review is a check, not a sign-off.** Nobody may know the full system, so the memory is reviewed and improved, not formally approved.
- **Pauses rely on the agent's instructions.** Copilot is configured to stop after each phase, but a user should stop it with HALT if it runs ahead.
- **Pace depends on answers.** Most of the elapsed time is spent waiting for clarifications from people, not on the agent's work.
- **Large systems are handled in batches.** Hundreds of objects and documents are processed in parts with checklists, so nothing is skipped, but the first memory build takes time.